

## 9. The First Mercy

Bruce Blunt

Peter Warlock

**Allegretto con moto**

Voice

Piano

*mp* *legato*

Ox and ass at Beth - le - hem

5

On a night, ye know of them. We were on - ly crea - tures small,

9

hid by sha - dows on the wall.

*Red.* \*

13

We were swal - low, moth and mouse; The Child was born

*p*

16

in our house. And the bright eyes of us three

19

Peeped at His na - ti - vi - ty.

23

Hands of peace up - on that place Hushed our be - ings for... a space -

*pp*

27

Qui - et feet and fold - ed wing, Nor a sound of

30

a - ny - thing. With a mov - ing

*p sempre legato*

34

star we crept Clo - ser when the Ba - by slept

37

Men who guard - ed where He lay Moved to fright - en

40

us a - way. But the Babe, a -

*mf*

*Red.* \*

44

- wa - kened, laid Love on things that were..... a - fraid;

47

With so sweet a ges - ture He Called us to His com - pan - y.

*mp* *mf*

51

*f* *p* *mp*

*Red.* \*